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(54) **AIR-COOLED REFRIGERATOR**

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See application file for complete search history.

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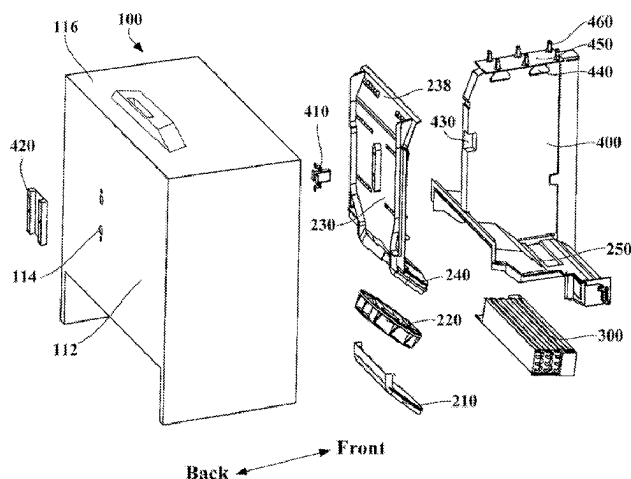
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

An air-cooled refrigerator comprises a bottom liner, a fan bottom shell, an air duct cover plate, and fan blades. A cooling chamber and a storage space are defined in the bottom liner. The fan bottom shell is arranged at a rear portion of the cooling chamber. The air duct cover plate comprises a back plate portion and a fan upper cover. The

(Continued)



back plate portion is disposed in front of a rear wall of the bottom liner. The fan upper cover obliquely extends downward from a lower end of the back plate portion into the cooling chamber, covers the fan bottom shell and is fastened thereto. The back plate portion and the fan upper cover are integrally formed. The fan blades are arranged in a fan cavity, and enable formation of a refrigeration airflow discharged from the cooling chamber to an air supply duct.

8 Claims, 8 Drawing Sheets

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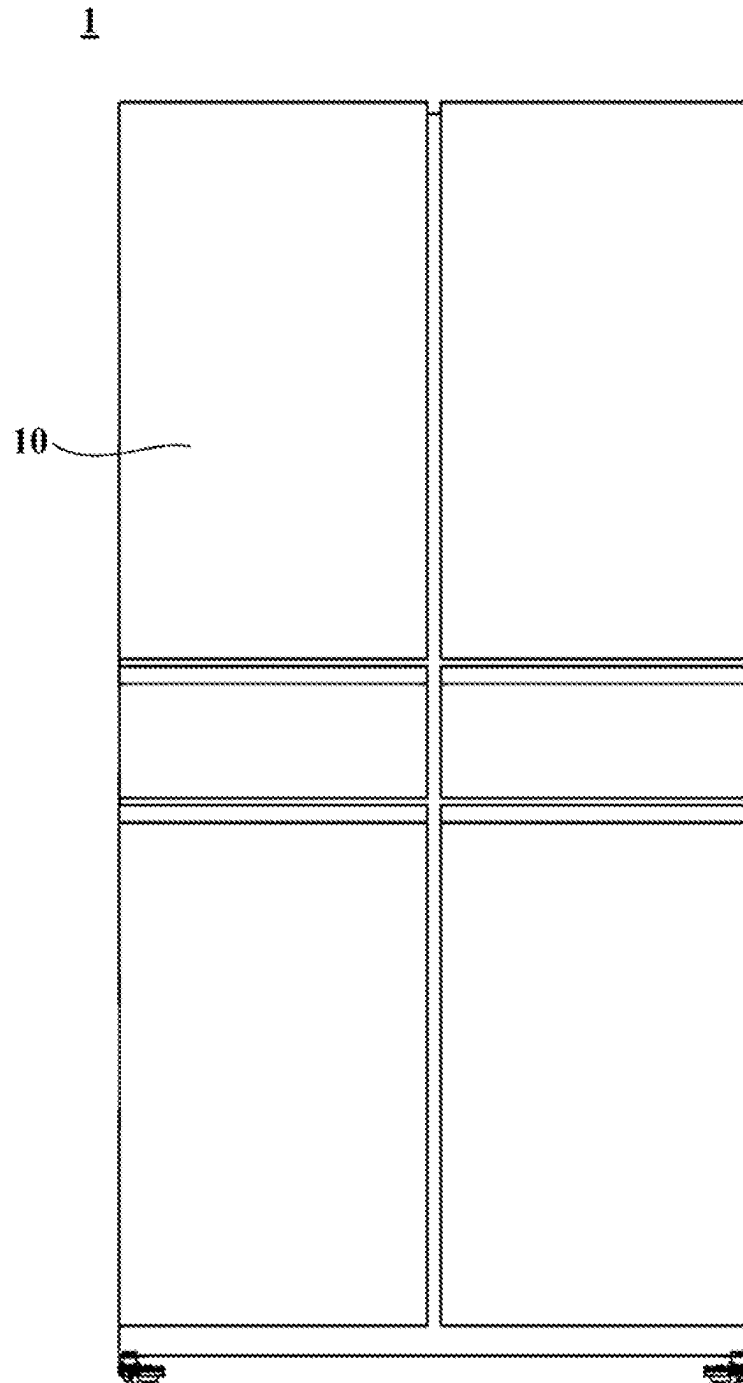


FIG. 1

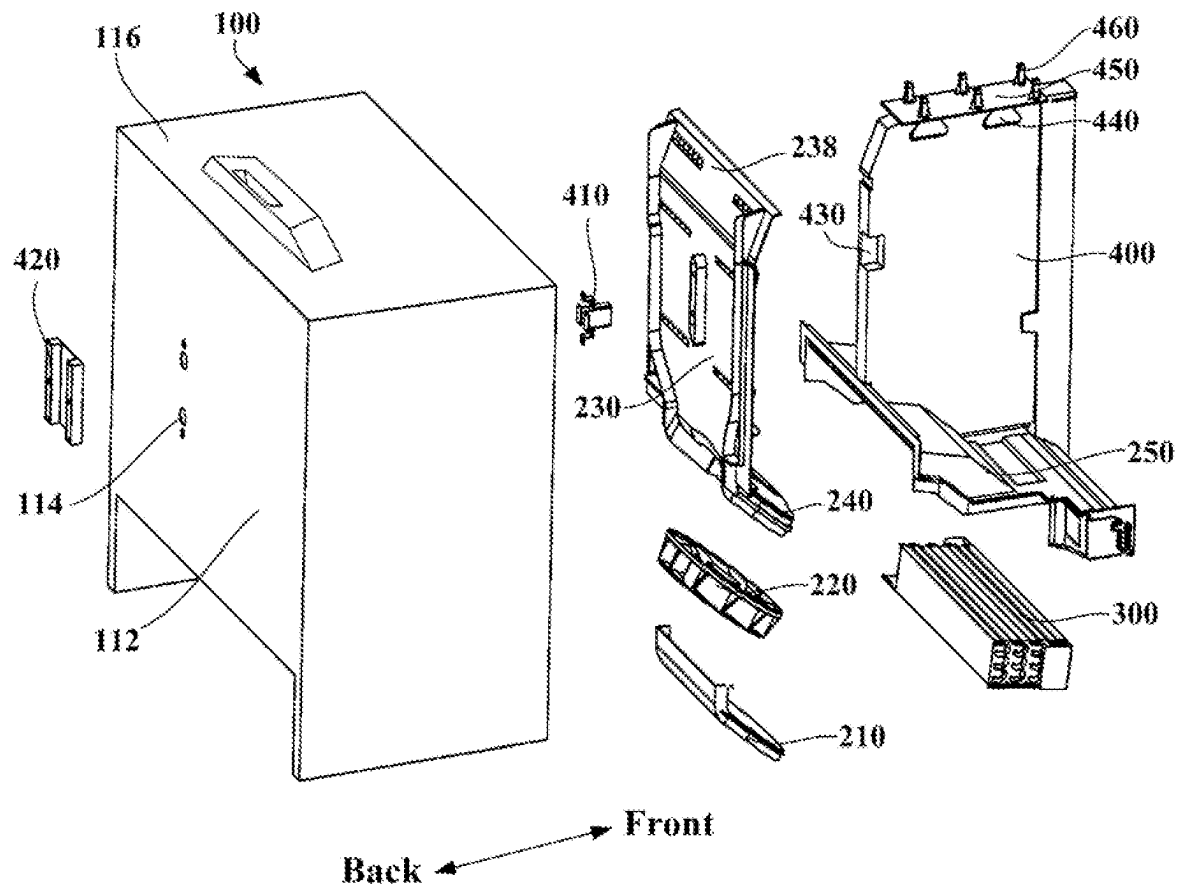


FIG. 2

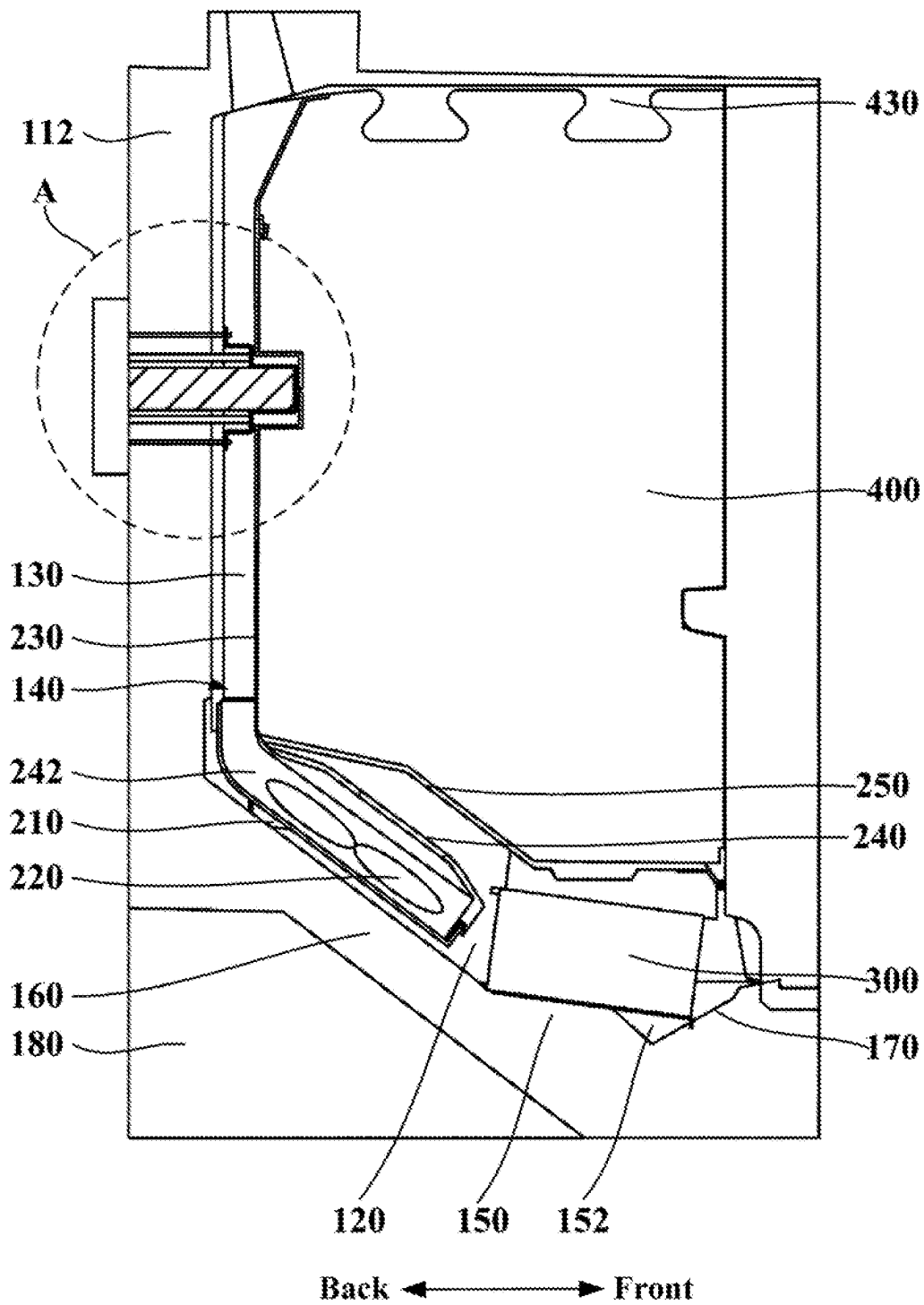


FIG. 3

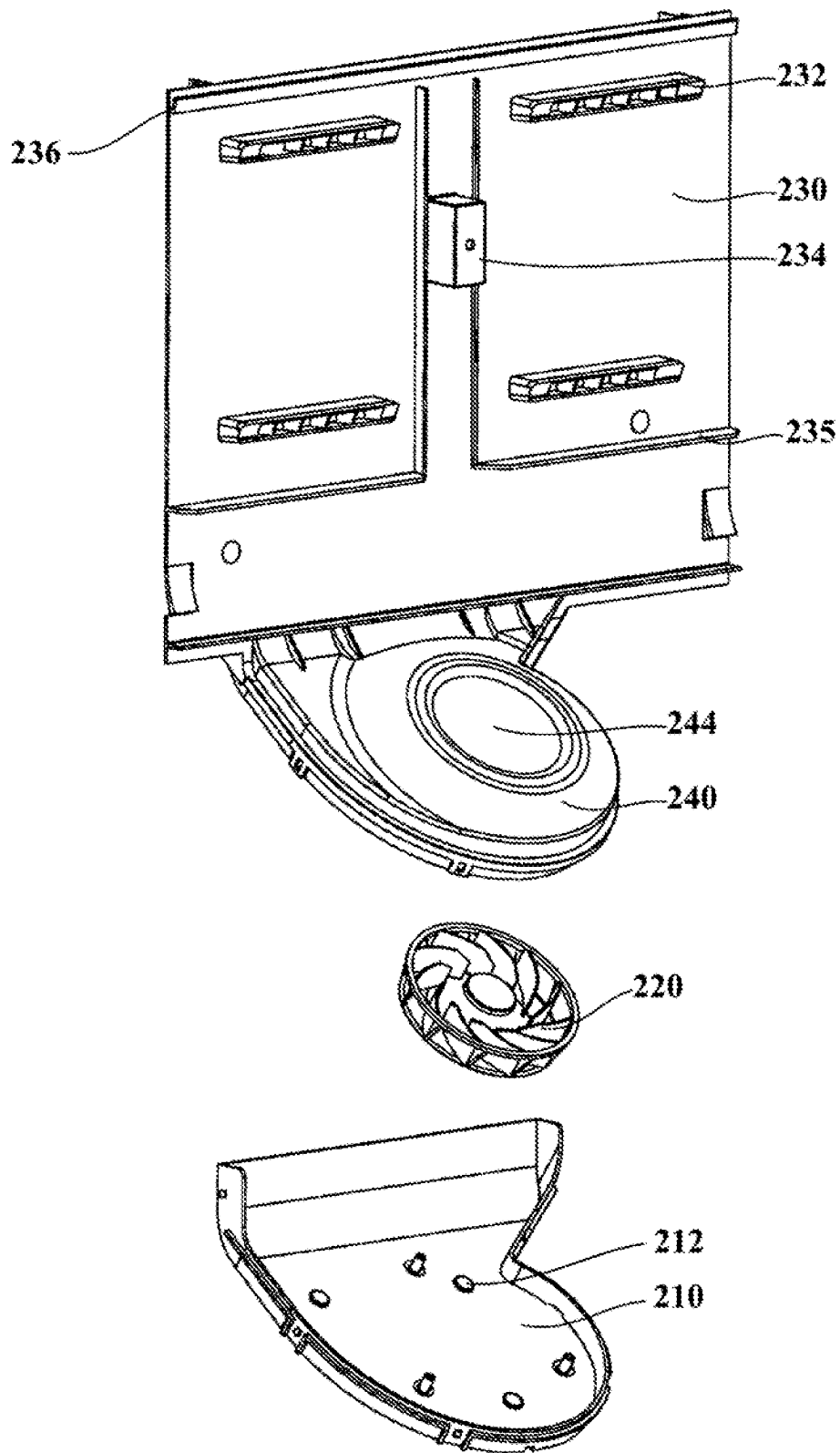


FIG. 4

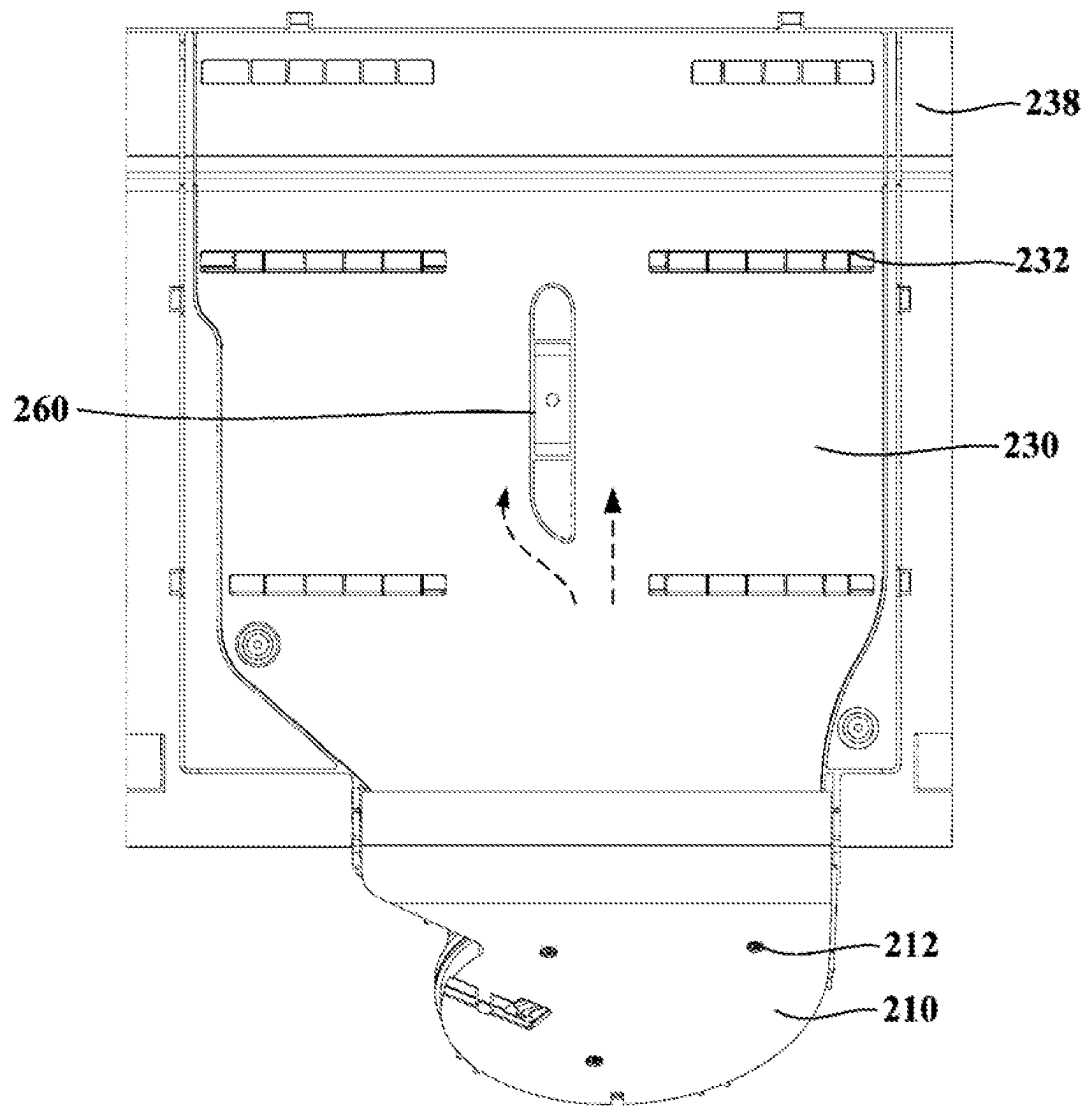


FIG. 5

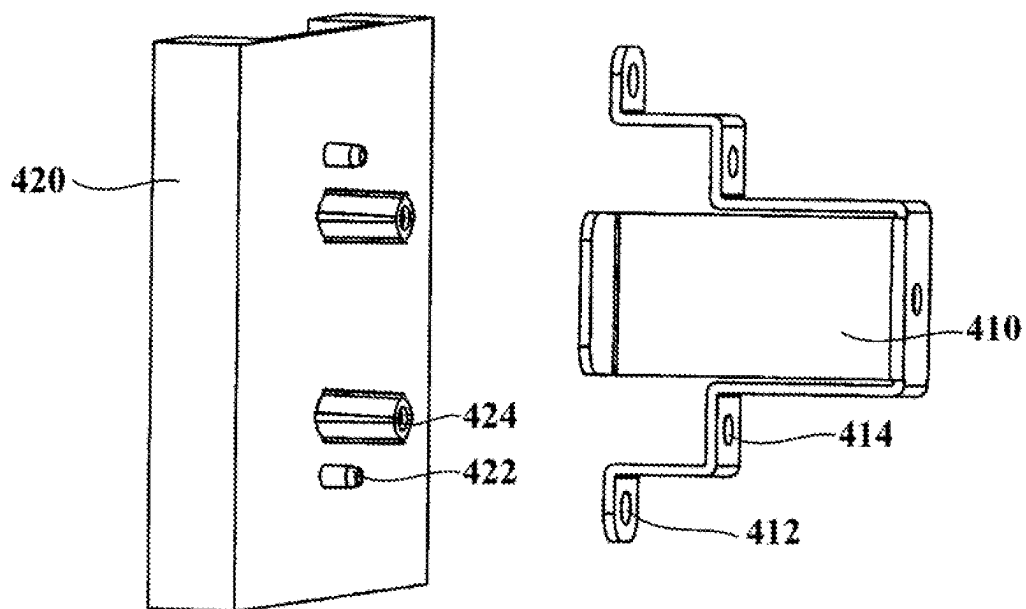


FIG. 6

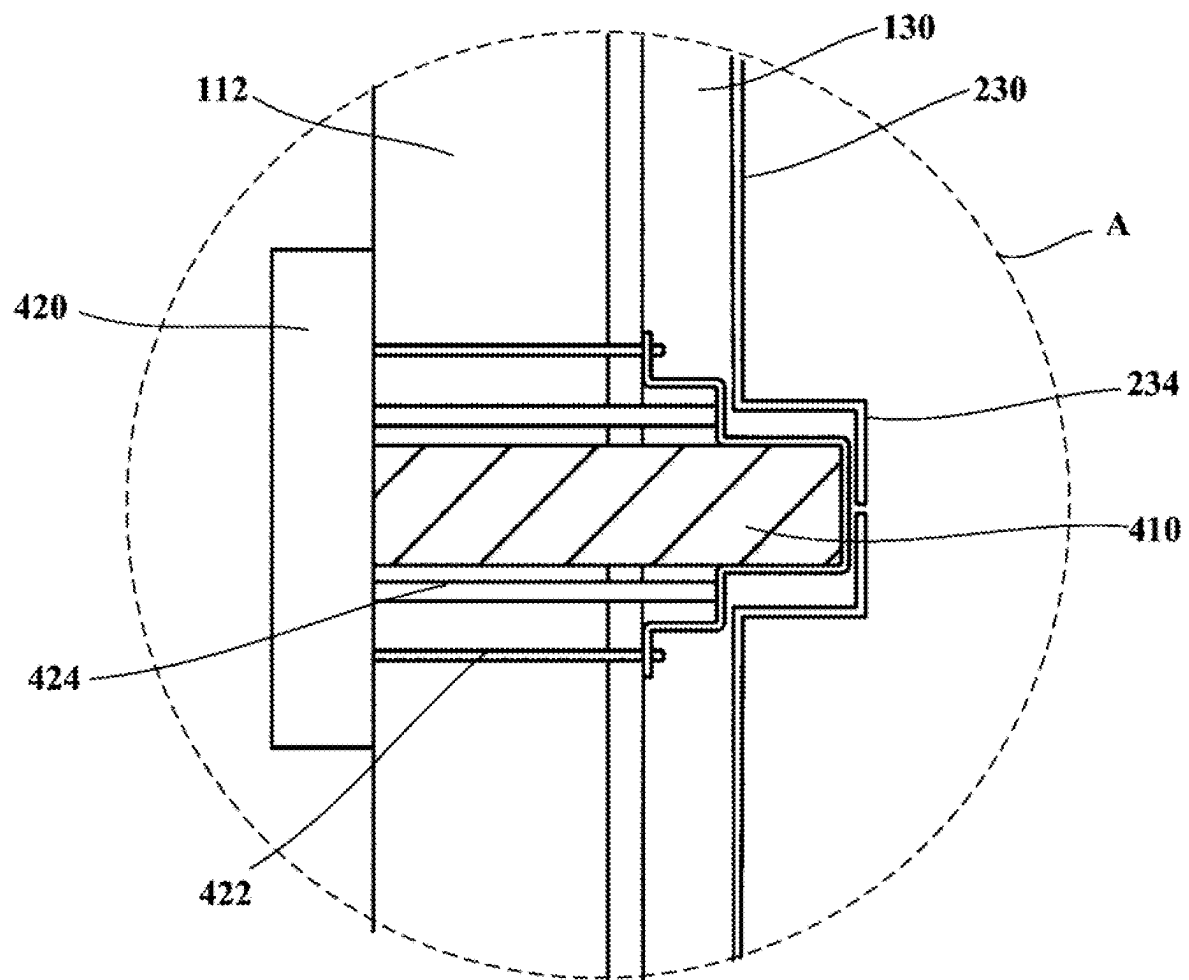


FIG. 7

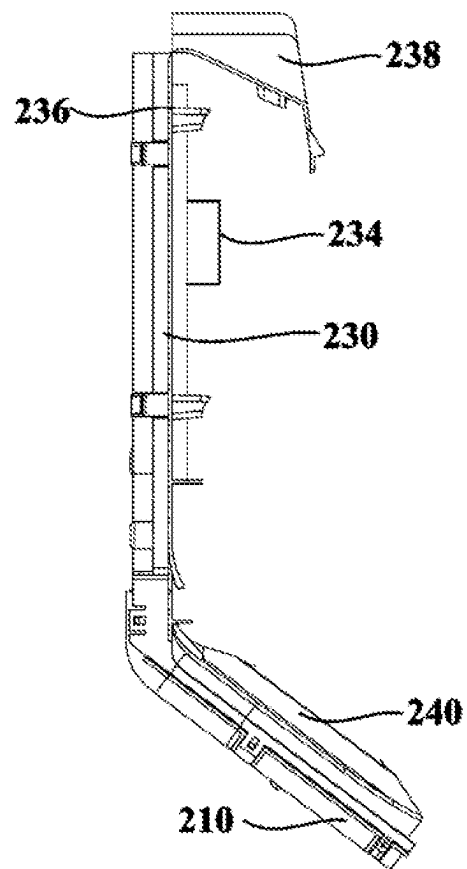


FIG. 8

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AIR-COOLED REFRIGERATOR**CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATION**

This application is a U.S. national stage application of PCT Patent Application No. PCT/CN2021/112992 filed Aug. 17, 2021, which claims priority to and the benefit of Chinese Application No. 202010833861.3 filed Aug. 18, 2020, which are incorporated herein in their entireties by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to refrigerating and freezing technologies, and particularly relates to an air-cooled refrigerator.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

In an existing refrigerator, a duct plate and a fan volute provided in the duct plate are generally two devices independent of each other. During assembly, an installer generally needs to connect the duct plate with the fan volute by means of a large number of fasteners, which may lead to a complex installation process and increased cost, thus being not conducive to mass production.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

One objective of the present invention is to overcome at least one defect in the prior art and to provide an air-cooled refrigerator.

One further objective of the present invention is to simplify installation processes of the refrigerator.

Another further objective of the present invention is to fix a rear end of a longitudinal partition to a bottom liner, so as to reduce the weight borne by an evaporator upper cover and improve the stability of the refrigerator.

Particularly, the present invention provides an air-cooled refrigerator, including:

a bottom liner, defining a cooling chamber and a storage space, the cooling chamber being provided below the storage space;

a fan bottom shell, provided at a rear portion of the cooling chamber; and

an air duct cover plate, including:

a back plate portion, provided in front of a rear wall of the bottom liner, and defining an air supply duct together with the rear wall of the bottom liner, at least one air supply outlet being formed in the back plate portion, and the air supply outlet being configured to make the air supply duct communicate with the storage space; and

a fan upper cover, obliquely extending downwards from a lower end of the back plate portion into the cooling chamber, covering the fan bottom shell and being fastened thereto to form, together with the fan bottom shell, a fan cavity for accommodating fan blades, the back plate portion and the fan upper cover being integrally formed;

the air-cooled refrigerator also including:

the fan blades, provided inside the fan cavity, and enabling formation of a refrigeration air flow discharged from the cooling chamber to the air supply duct.

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Further, the fan blades are centrifugal blades, and the fan cavity formed by the fan upper cover and the fan bottom shell has a volute shape, an air inlet being formed in the fan upper cover, and an exhaust outlet being formed at a position where the fan upper cover is connected with the back plate portion.

Further, the air-cooled refrigerator also includes:

an evaporator, having an overall flat cuboid shape and being arranged on a front portion of the cooling chamber;

a bottom wall of the bottom liner including:

an evaporator supporting part, configured to support the evaporator; and

a fan supporting part, obliquely provided upwards from front to back from a rear end of the evaporator supporting part, the fan bottom shell being fixed to the fan supporting part, such that the fan cavity is overall obliquely provided behind the evaporator.

Further, a bottom of the fan bottom shell is provided with a plurality of damping adhesive pads, and bonded to the fan supporting part by using the plurality of damping adhesive pads.

Further, the air-cooled refrigerator also includes:

a longitudinal partition, vertically provided in a middle of the storage space to separate the storage space into two transversely-arranged storage cavities; and

a back fixing assembly, provided on the rear wall of the bottom liner, and having a supporting block facing the storage space to support the longitudinal partition by using the supporting block.

Further, the back fixing assembly includes:

a supporting base, fixed to a rear side of a back portion of the bottom liner; and

a bearing frame, provided on a front side of the back portion of the bottom liner, and connected with the supporting base by means of a fastener, the bearing frame protruding towards the storage space to form the supporting block, and

the back plate portion forms a supporting jacket protruding towards the storage space at a position corresponding to the bearing frame, the supporting block is inserted into the supporting jacket, and the supporting jacket is matched with a fixing structure provided at a rear end of the longitudinal partition, such that the longitudinal partition is supported by matching the supporting jacket with the fixing structure of the longitudinal partition.

Further, one side of the back plate portion facing the air supply duct forms an air guiding jacket on a periphery of the bearing frame to avoid an air flow from forming a turbulent flow at the bearing frame.

Further, the air guiding jacket is provided extending along a height direction of the back plate portion, and forms a streamline tip at its bottom end to guide the air flow by using the tip.

Further, the air duct cover plate is an integrally injection-molded single-layer plate, and an upper portion of the back plate portion is provided with a crease groove to facilitate bending of the back plate portion by using the crease groove when installing the air duct cover plate.

Further, the back plate portion is also provided with at least one transversely extending water retaining rib below the air supply outlet to block condensate water at the air supply outlet from flowing downwards into the fan cavity.

In the air-cooled refrigerator of the present invention, the back plate portion and the fan upper cover are integrally formed to form modularization and facilitate batch produc-

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tion, and during assembly, the installer may install an integrally-formed piece first, and then may directly connect an evaporator upper cover with the integrally-formed piece, thereby simplifying installation processes and reducing costs, and ensuring the stability of a whole air duct structure.

In the air-cooled refrigerator of the present invention, the bottom liner is provided with the longitudinal partition, the rear end of the longitudinal partition abuts against the air duct cover plate, the back plate portion forms the supporting jacket protruding towards the storage space, the rear end of the longitudinal partition is provided with a sunken part matched with the supporting jacket of the back plate portion, the supporting block may extend into the supporting jacket, and then an assembly formed by the supporting block and the supporting jacket extends into the sunken part; in this way, the rear wall of the bottom liner, the back plate portion and the longitudinal partition are fixed together by means of the back fixing assembly, so as to transfer part of the weight of the longitudinal partition to the rear wall of the bottom liner, thereby sharing the pressure of the evaporator upper cover.

These and other objectives, advantages and features of the present invention will be better understood by those skilled in the art in the light of the detailed description of specific embodiments of the present invention in conjunction with the accompanying drawings below.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

Some specific embodiments of the present invention will be described below in detail in an exemplary and non-limiting manner with reference to the accompanying drawings. Identical reference numerals in the accompanying drawings indicate identical or similar components or parts. It should be understood by those skilled in the art that these accompanying drawings are not necessarily drawn to scale. In the drawings:

FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 2 is an exploded view of a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention, with a housing being hidden;

FIG. 3 is a sectional view of a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention, with a housing being hidden;

FIG. 4 is a diagram of position relationships between a fan bottom shell, fan blades and an air duct cover plate in a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention, with a bend segment on a back plate portion being hidden;

FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of an air duct cover plate in a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention, with a bend segment on a back plate portion being hidden and a dashed line showing a direction of an air flow flowing through an air guiding jacket;

FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of a back fixing assembly in a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 7 is an enlarged view of part A in FIG. 3; and

FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of another view of an air duct cover plate in a refrigerator according to an embodiment of the present invention, showing a state of folding down by 90 degrees of a bend segment on a back plate portion.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

In the description of the embodiment, it should be understood that, orientation or position relationships indicated by

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terms “longitudinal,” “transverse,” “length,” “width,” “thickness,” “upper,” “lower,” “front,” “rear,” “left,” “right,” “vertical,” “horizontal,” “top,” “bottom,” “depth,” etc. are based on orientations of a refrigerator in normal use as a reference, and can be determined with reference to orientation or position relationships as shown in accompanying drawings. For example, “front” for indicating an orientation refers to a side of the refrigerator facing a user. It is merely for ease of describing the present invention and simplifying the description, and not for indicating or implying the device or component referred to should have a specific orientation and be constructed and operated in the specific orientation, and thus it cannot be interpreted as the limitation on the present invention.

See FIG. 1, a refrigerator 1 of the embodiment may generally include a refrigerator body 10. The refrigerator body 10 may be composed of a housing, a liner, a heat insulation layer and other accessories. The housing is an outer layer structure of the refrigerator, and protects the whole refrigerator. In order to isolate heat conduction from the outside, the heat insulation layer is added between the housing and the liner of the refrigerator body 10, and the heat insulation layer is generally made by means of a foaming process. There may be one or more liners, which may be arbitrarily divided into a refrigerating liner, a variable temperature liner, a freezing liner and the like according to functions. The specific number and functions of the liners may be configured according to usage demands of the refrigerator. In the embodiment, the liner at least includes a bottom liner 100, which may generally be a freezing liner.

See FIGS. 2 to 4, the refrigerator 1 may also include a fan bottom shell 210, fan blades 220 and an air duct cover plate. A cooling chamber 120 and a storage space are defined in the bottom liner 100. The cooling chamber 120 is provided below the storage space. The fan bottom shell 210 is provided on a rear portion of the cooling chamber 120.

The air duct cover plate may also include a back plate portion 230 and a fan upper cover 240. The back plate portion 230 is provided in front of a rear wall 112 of the bottom liner 100, and defines an air supply duct 130 together with the rear wall 112 of the bottom liner 100, and at least one air supply outlet 232 is formed in the back plate portion 230 and configured to make the air supply duct 130 communicate with the storage space. The fan upper cover 240 obliquely extends downwards from a lower end of the back plate portion 230 into the cooling chamber 140, covers the fan bottom shell 210 and is fastened thereto to form, together with the fan bottom shell 210, a fan cavity 242 for accommodating the fan blades 220, and the back plate portion 230 and the fan upper cover 240 are integrally formed. The fan blades 220 are provided inside the fan cavity 242, and enable the formation of a refrigeration air flow discharged from the cooling chamber 120 to the air supply duct 130.

In the embodiment, an evaporator upper cover 250 is provided at a lower portion of the bottom liner 100. The evaporator upper cover 250 is transversely provided inside the bottom liner 120 and configured to define the liner 100 as the cooling chamber 120 and the storage space. The cooling chamber 120 is provided below the storage space, and an evaporator 300 is provided inside the cooling chamber 120.

That is, the evaporator 300 in the embodiment is provided at the lower portion of the bottom liner 100, and such a manner may avoid the reduction of depth of a freezing compartment due to the occupation of a rear space of the freezing compartment by an evaporator in a traditional refrigerator. Especially for a side-by-side refrigerator, it is

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especially important to increase the depth dimension of the freezing compartment when its transverse dimension is small. Thus, the space utilization of the refrigerator **1** is improved, and objects that are large and difficult to be divided are stored advantageously.

Additionally, in the traditional refrigerator, the freezing compartment on the lowest portion has a low position, a user needs to bend down significantly or squat down to pick up and place objects in the freezing compartment. Thus, it is inconvenient for the user to use, especially for the elderly. However, in the embodiment, since the lower space of the bottom liner **100** is occupied by the cooling chamber **120**, the height of the storage space above the cooling chamber **120** is raised, and the degree of bending down is reduced when the user picks up and places the objects in the storage space, thereby improving the user experience of the user.

In the embodiment, the evaporator **300** has an overall flat cuboid shape, is arranged at the front portion of the cooling chamber **120**, and is obliquely provided in the cooling chamber **120**. This mode breaks through the technical shackles that, in the prior art, an evaporator needs to be placed horizontally to reduce the depth dimension. Although oblique placement of the flat cuboid evaporator **300** may increase the length in a front-back direction, it makes other components inside the cooling chamber **120** arranged more reasonably, and it is verified from actual analysis of an air flow field that air circulation efficiency is higher, and water drainage is smoother. The layout of oblique placement of the evaporator **300** is one of the main technical improvements made in the embodiment. In some specific embodiments, an inclination angle of the evaporator **300** is set within a range from 7 to 8 degrees, e.g., 7 degrees, 7.5 degrees and 8 degrees, preferably 7.5 degrees.

The back plate portion **230** may serve as at least one portion of a duct plate of the bottom liner **100**, may be roughly parallel to the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**, and is located in front of the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner, so as to define the air supply duct **130** together with the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner. The fan upper cover **240** obliquely extends downwards from the lower end of the back plate portion **230** into the cooling chamber **120**. Since the evaporator upper cover **250** serves as a separation part between the cooling chamber **120** and the storage space, that is, the evaporator upper cover **250** is located above the fan upper cover **240**, the upper end of the evaporator upper cover **250** may be connected with the back plate portion **230**, so as to play a role in sealing a gap between the cooling chamber **120** and the air supply duct **130**.

In the embodiment, the back plate portion **230** and the fan upper cover **240** are integrally formed. Such manner is different from a duct plate and a fan volute in the prior art. As mentioned in the background art, in an existing refrigerator, the duct plate and the fan volute provided in the duct plate are generally two devices independent of each other. During assembly, an installer generally needs to connect the duct plate with the fan volute by means of a large number of fasteners, which may lead to a complex installation process and increased cost, thus being not conducive to mass production.

However, in the embodiment, the back plate portion **230** and the fan upper cover **240** are integrally formed to form modularization, thereby facilitating mass production. And during assembly, the installer may install an integrally-formed piece first, and then may directly connect the evaporator upper cover **250** with the integrally-formed piece, thereby simplifying installation processes and reducing costs, and ensuring the stability of a whole air duct structure.

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In the embodiment, the fan bottom shell **210** is provided at the rear portion of the cooling chamber **120** and located below the fan upper cover **240**. The middle of the fan bottom shell **210** is sunken downwards, and the outer edges thereof are provided with a plurality of buckles (not shown in the figures). Clamping grooves matched with the buckles of the fan bottom shell are formed at the outer edges of the fan upper cover to fix the fan bottom shell **210** to the fan upper cover **240**.

The fan bottom shell **210** and the fan upper cover **240** form the fan cavity **242** for accommodating the fan blades **220**. The fan blades **220** are provided inside the fan cavity **242**. The evaporator **300** inside the cooling chamber **120** conducts heat exchange with surrounding air, so as to make its temperature reduced. The fan blades **220** prompt the refrigeration air flow to be discharged from the cooling chamber **120** to the air supply duct **130**, and then to enter the storage space from the air supply outlet **232** in the back plate portion **230**, so as to conduct heat exchange with air in the storage space to reduce the temperature of the storage space. The evaporator upper cover **250** may also have a return air inlet (not shown in the figures) on its front side that makes the storage space communicate with the cooling chamber **120**, such that after heat exchange, the refrigeration air flow may flow back to the cooling chamber **120** via the return air inlet to continue the heat exchange with the evaporator **300**, so as to form a circulating air flow path.

See FIGS. 2 to 4, in some specific embodiments, the fan blades **220** may also be centrifugal blades. The fan cavity **242** formed by the fan upper cover **240** and the fan bottom shell **210** has a volute shape. An air inlet **244** is formed in the fan upper cover **240**. An exhaust outlet **140** is formed at a position where the fan upper cover **240** is connected with the back plate portion **230**.

The centrifugal blades may make an air flow from the air inlet **244** discharged in a direction perpendicular to the air inlet **244**. In the embodiment, the fan upper cover **240** is provided with the air inlet **244**. The air flow from the cooling chamber **120** is sucked by the centrifugal blades and then discharged to the fan cavity **242** in the direction perpendicular to the air inlet **244**. The exhaust outlet **140** is formed at the position where the fan upper cover **240** is connected with the back plate portion **230**. The exhaust outlet **140** is connected with the fan cavity **242** and the air supply duct **130** to convey the refrigeration air flow pressurized by the fan blades **220** to the air supply duct **130**.

See FIG. 3, in some embodiments of the present invention, a bottom wall of the bottom liner **100** includes an evaporator supporting part **150** and a fan supporting part **160**. The evaporator supporting part **150** is configured to support the evaporator **300**. The fan supporting part **160** is obliquely provided upwards from front to back from a rear end of the evaporator supporting part **150**. The fan bottom shell **210** is fixed to the fan supporting part **160**, such that the fan cavity **242** is overall obliquely provided behind the evaporator **300**.

In the embodiment, the evaporator supporting part **150** is connected with the fan supporting part **160**, and may serve as a part of a separation plate in a refrigerator body **10** for separating the liner **100** from a compressor compartment **180**. An oblique part **170** may also be provided in front of the evaporator supporting part **150**. The oblique part **170** is obliquely provided downwards from front to back from a front end of the bottom wall of the bottom liner **100**. The evaporator supporting part **150** is obliquely provided upwards from front to back from a rear end of the oblique part **170**, so as to obliquely provide the evaporator **300** in the

cooling chamber **120**, and a drainage channel **152** is formed at a position where the oblique part **170** is connected with the evaporator supporting part **150**, so as to receive defrosting water on the evaporator **300**.

The fan supporting part **160** is obliquely provided upwards from front to back from the rear end of the evaporator supporting part **150**. In some preferable embodiments, an inclination angle of the fan supporting part **160** is greater than that of the evaporator supporting part **150**. The inclination angle of the fan supporting part **160** is set within a range from 36 to 37 degrees relative to the horizontal direction, e.g., 36 degrees, 36.5 degrees and 37 degrees, preferably 36.7 degrees. Correspondingly, the fan bottom shell **210** acts on the fan supporting part **160**, and may also be obliquely provided at the angle mentioned above.

See FIGS. 4 and 5, in some embodiments of the present invention, the bottom of the fan bottom shell **210** is provided with a plurality of damping adhesive pads **212**, and bonded to the fan supporting part **160** by using the plurality of damping adhesive pads **212**. The damping adhesive pads **212** are made of flexible and viscous materials. As shown in FIGS. 4 and 5, the bottom of the fan bottom shell **210** is provided with three damping adhesive pads **212** protruding outwards, which are distributed on the lower portion of the fan bottom shell **210** roughly at 120 degrees, so as to bond the fan supporting part **160** to the fan bottom shell **210**. Meanwhile, the damping adhesive pads **212** made of the flexible materials may also effectively reduce noise of the fan blades **220** during operation, and reduce the vibration transfer efficiency of the fan blades during operation, thereby improving the user's sense of experience. It should be illustrated that the number of the damping adhesive pads **212** may also be set as two, four, five and more, and the specific number and distribution positions of the damping adhesive pads **212** are not particularly specified in the present invention.

See FIGS. 2 to 7, in some embodiments of the present invention, the refrigerator **1** may also include a longitudinal partition **400** and a back fixing assembly. The longitudinal partition **400** is vertically provided in the middle of the storage space to separate the storage space into two transversely-arranged storage cavities. The back fixing assembly is arranged on the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**, and has a supporting block **410** facing the storage space so as to support the longitudinal partition **400** by using the supporting block **410**.

In the embodiment, the longitudinal partition **400** may be provided between the evaporator upper cover **250** and a top wall of the storage space, and a rear portion of the longitudinal partition **400** may abut against the back plate portion **230**, so as to separate the storage space into the two transversely-arranged storage cavities while ensuring the two transversely-arranged storage cavities share the same evaporator **300**.

As for an existing refrigerator with a partition in a liner, the partition is mainly borne by a supporting structure of a front end vertical beam and a support of a bottom cover plate, there is no bearing structure provided at a back duct, and consequently, there is a certain risk of bearing in the rear portion.

In order to overcome the defects in the prior art, in the refrigerator **1** of the embodiment, the back fixing assembly is provided on the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**, and the longitudinal partition **400** is supported by the supporting block **410**, such that the longitudinal partition is indirectly connected with the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**, so as to distribute part of the weight of the longitudinal partition

400 to the bottom liner **100**, thereby reducing the weight borne by the evaporator upper cover **250** and avoiding the evaporator upper cover **250** from deforming due to excessive weight bearing.

Specifically, the back fixing assembly may also include a supporting base **420** and a bearing frame, and the supporting base **420** is fixed to the rear side of the back portion of the bottom liner **100**. The bearing frame is provided on the front side of the back portion of the bottom liner **100** and connected with the supporting base **420** by means of a fastener, and the bearing frame protrudes towards the storage space to form the supporting block **410**; and the back plate portion **230** forms a supporting jacket **234** protruding towards the storage space at a position corresponding to the bearing frame, the supporting block **410** is inserted into the supporting jacket **234**, and the supporting jacket **234** is matched with a fixing structure provided at the rear end of the longitudinal partition **400**, such that the longitudinal partition **400** is supported by matching the supporting jacket **234** with the fixing structure of the longitudinal partition **400**.

A surface of the supporting base **420** facing the bottom liner **100** has a plurality of protruding positioning pins **422** and a plurality of protruding fixing columns **424**, and threads may be formed in the fixing columns **424**; and correspondingly, the bearing frame is provided with a plurality of positioning holes **412** connected with the positioning pins **422** in a nesting manner and a plurality of connecting holes **414** connected with the fixing columns **424**, and installation holes **114** allowing the positioning pins **422** and the fixing columns **424** to extend thereinto are formed in the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**. The positioning pins **422** penetrate through the installation holes **114** and then extend into the positioning holes **412**, and the fixing columns **424** are fixed to the connecting holes **414** by means of fasteners, such that the supporting base **420** and the supporting block **410** are fixedly provided on the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**.

The fixing structure provided at the rear end of the longitudinal partition is a sunken part **430** matched with the supporting jacket **234**, the back plate portion **230** forms the supporting jacket **234** protruding towards the storage space at the position corresponding to the bearing frame, the supporting block **410** may extend into the supporting jacket **234**, and then an assembly formed by the supporting block **410** and the supporting jacket **234** extend into the sunken part **430**; in this way, the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**, the back plate portion **230** and the longitudinal partition **400** are fixed together by means of the back fixing assembly, so as to transfer part of the weight of the longitudinal partition **400** to the rear wall **112** of the bottom liner **100**, thereby sharing the pressure of the evaporator upper cover **250**.

In the embodiment, the upper portion of the longitudinal partition **400** may also be provided with an upper portion fixing piece. The upper portion fixing piece may also include a hooking part **440**, a hanging plate **450** and an elastic clamping jaw **460**. The top of the longitudinal partition **400** may also be correspondingly provided with a hooking matching part matched with the hooking part **440**. The hanging plate **450** may have a shape of a flat plate, and may abut against the lower portion or the upper portion of a top wall **116** of the bottom liner or may be arranged inside the top wall **116** of the bottom liner. The elastic clamping jaw **460** may extend upwards from an upper surface of the hanging plate **450** so as to be connected with a supporting body of the upper portion fixing piece to further distribute

the weight of the longitudinal partition **400** to the bottom liner **100** and the supporting body of the upper portion fixing piece, thereby further sharing the pressure of the evaporator upper cover **250**.

See FIG. 5, in some embodiments of the present invention, a side of the back plate portion **230** facing the air supply duct **130** forms the air guiding jacket **260** on the periphery of the bearing frame to avoid the air flow from forming a turbulent flow at the bearing frame.

When the supporting block **410** is inserted into the supporting jacket **234**, the air flow flowing through the supporting block **410** tends to form a turbulent flow above the supporting block **410** after being subjected to interference, causing a certain loss of wind speed. The air guiding jacket **260** in the embodiment may guide the air flow flowing through the supporting block **410**, thereby making the air flow smoother.

See FIG. 5, the dashed line in FIG. 5 shows the air flow flowing through the air guiding jacket **260**. Specifically, the air guiding jacket **260** is provided extending along the height direction of the back plate portion **230**, and forms a streamline tip at its bottom end to guide the air flow by using the tip. The streamline tip may have a shape that gradually expands upwards from a lower portion thereof, and at least one edge is provided into a smooth arc shape to make the air flow pass through the supporting block **410** smoothly, thereby reducing resistance to the air flow.

See FIGS. 4 and 8, in some embodiments of the present invention, the air duct cover plate is an integrally injection-molded single-layer plate, and the upper portion of the back plate portion **230** is provided with a crease groove **236** to facilitate bending of the back plate portion **230** by using the crease groove **236** when installing the air duct cover plate.

In the embodiment, the upper portion of the back plate portion **230** is provided with a bend segment **238**, and the lower portion of the bend segment **238** may extend into the crease groove **236** and may rotate around the crease groove **236** by a certain angle to reduce the height of the back plate portion **230**. During installation, the installer may make the bend segment **28** extend into the crease groove **236** and rotate outwards by a certain angle (as shown in FIG. 8, making the bend segment **238** rotate outwards by 90 degrees) to reduce the height of the back plate portion **230**. Then, the installer may connect the rest of the air duct cover plate with the liner **100** or other parts firstly, and finally fold the bend segment **238** to an original position to simplify the installation processes.

See FIG. 4, in some embodiments of the present invention, the back plate portion **230** is also provided with at least one transversely extending water retaining rib **235** below the air supply outlet **232** to block condensate water at the air supply outlet **232** from flowing downwards into the fan cavity **242**.

In the embodiment, the water retaining rib **235** may be provided on one side of the back plate portion **230** facing a storage compartment. Since there is part of the condensate water contained in the air flow, when the air flow encounters the back plate portion **230**, the condensate water may adhere to its surface, and the water retaining rib **235** may delay the descending of the condensate water and make all condensate water evaporate as far as possible to avoid a failure caused by the falling of the condensate water into the fan cavity **242**.

In the embodiment, transverse extension may refer to horizontal extension, or it may also be understood that the water retaining rib **235** has a certain inclination angle. Both of the above modes may delay the falling of the condensate water on the water retaining rib **235**.

At this point, it should be recognized by those skilled in the art that, although multiple exemplary embodiments of the present invention have been exhaustively shown and described herein, many other variations or modifications in accordance with the principles of the present invention may still be directly determined or derived from the disclosure of the present invention without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention. Therefore, the scope of the present invention should be understood and recognized as covering all these other variations or modifications.

What is claimed is:

1. An air-cooled refrigerator, comprising:

a bottom liner, defining a cooling chamber and a storage space, the cooling chamber being provided below the storage space;

a fan bottom shell, provided at a rear portion of the cooling chamber; and

an air duct cover plate, comprising:

a back plate portion, provided in front of a rear wall of the bottom liner, and defining an air supply duct together with the rear wall of the bottom liner, at least one air supply outlet being formed in the back plate portion, and the air supply outlet being configured to make the air supply duct communicate with the storage space; and

a fan upper cover, obliquely extending downwards from a lower end of the back plate portion into the cooling chamber, covering the fan bottom shell and being fastened thereto to form, together with the fan bottom shell, a fan cavity for accommodating fan blades, the back plate portion and the fan upper cover being integrally formed;

the air-cooled refrigerator further comprising:

the fan blades, provided inside the fan cavity, and enabling formation of a refrigeration air flow discharged from the cooling chamber to the air supply duct;

a longitudinal partition, vertically provided in a middle of the storage space to separate the storage space into two transversely-arranged storage cavities; and

a back fixing assembly, provided on the rear wall of the bottom liner, and having a supporting block protruding from the rear wall of the bottom liner towards the storage space to support the longitudinal partition by using the supporting block;

wherein the back fixing assembly comprises:

a supporting base, fixed to a rear side of a back portion of the bottom liner; and

a bearing frame, provided on a front side of the back portion of the bottom liner, and connected with the supporting base by means of a fastener, the bearing frame protruding towards the storage space to form the supporting block; and

wherein the back plate portion forms a supporting jacket protruding towards the storage space at a position corresponding to the bearing frame, the supporting block is inserted into the supporting jacket, and the supporting jacket is matched with a fixing structure provided at a rear end of the longitudinal partition, such that the longitudinal partition is supported by matching the supporting jacket with the fixing structure of the longitudinal partition.

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2. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 1, wherein
- the fan blades are centrifugal blades, and
 - the fan cavity formed by the fan upper cover and the fan bottom shell has a volute shape, an air inlet being formed in the fan upper cover, and an exhaust outlet being formed at a position where the fan upper cover is connected with the back plate portion.
3. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 2, further comprising:
- an evaporator, having an overall flat cuboid shape and being arranged at a front portion of the cooling chamber;
 - a bottom wall of the bottom liner comprising:
 - an evaporator supporting part, configured to support the evaporator; and
 - a fan supporting part, obliquely provided upwards from front to back from a rear end of the evaporator supporting part, the fan bottom shell being fixed to the fan supporting part, such that the fan cavity is overall obliquely provided behind the evaporator.
4. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 3, wherein
- a bottom of the fan bottom shell is provided with a plurality of damping adhesive pads, and bonded to the fan supporting part by using the plurality of damping adhesive pads.

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5. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 1, wherein
- one side of the back plate portion facing the air supply duct forms an air guiding jacket on a periphery of the bearing frame to avoid an air flow from forming a turbulent flow at the bearing frame.
6. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 5, wherein
- the air guiding jacket is provided extending along a height direction of the back plate portion, and forms a streamline tip at its bottom end to guide the air flow by using the tip.
7. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 1, wherein
- the air duct cover plate is an integrally injection-molded single-layer plate, and an upper portion of the back plate portion is provided with a crease groove to facilitate bending of the back plate portion by using the crease groove when installing the air duct cover plate.
8. The air-cooled refrigerator according to claim 1, wherein
- the back plate portion is also provided with at least one transversely extending water retaining rib below the air supply outlet to block condensate water at the air supply outlet from flowing downwards into the fan cavity.

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